These notes were kept during a single season on the northern shore, where the tide pools freeze at the edges in March and the first warblers return in the middle of April. They are not a scientific record. They are a list of things that were noticed, written down before they could be forgotten, in the order in which they happened.

The first entry concerns a heron that stood in the same shallow pool every morning for eleven days. It caught nothing that anyone saw. On the twelfth day it was

gone, and the pool had a thin skin of ice that cracked like glass when a pebble was thrown onto it. Nobody could say whether the heron had known the cold was coming or had simply grown tired of waiting for a fish that never arrived in that particular pool, which was the smallest of the seven along the path to the old pier.

The second entry is about the light. In late April the sun rises over the water at an angle that turns the whole bay copper for about four minutes. If you are not

looking at that moment you will miss it entirely, and most people do.